

Trust & Titling Starter Checklist

Sentinel Enterprises LLC

Title accounts and assets correctly so your protection plan actually holds up

The Wrong Name on the Wrong Document Can Cost Your Family Everything

Creating a trust is only half the job. This checklist makes sure your assets are actually titled the right way.

The big idea

A trust with nothing properly titled into it is just an expensive stack of paper. Titling is where the real protection happens.

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Why Titling Matters (Plain English)

Titling means: whose name is on the legal ownership document. If you have a trust but your bank account is not IN the trust, the trust does not protect that account.

NO - WRONG

Assets OUTSIDE the trust

- Home in your name
- Bank in your name
- Trust sits empty

YES - RIGHT

Assets INSIDE the trust

- Home in trust name
- Bank in trust name
- Trust is funded

The #1 mistake

Most people create a trust but forget to fund it. An unfunded trust protects NOTHING.

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Types of Ownership (Explained Simply)

Sole Ownership

Only your name. When you die, it goes through probate court — slow, public, and costly.

Joint Tenancy

Two or more people. When one dies, the other automatically gets it — no probate.

Tenancy in Common

Two or more people, but each share goes to that person's own heirs separately.

Community Property

For married couples in certain states. Each spouse owns half.

Trust Ownership

The trust owns it. Strongest protection and avoids probate entirely.

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The Checklist: Assets to Review

REAL ESTATE

- ☐ Primary home — how is it titled?
- ☐ Vacation property or rental property
- ☐ Land or undeveloped property

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTS

- ☐ Checking accounts
- ☐ Savings accounts
- ☐ Investment/brokerage accounts
- ☐ CDs or money market accounts

RETIREMENT ACCOUNTS

- ☐ IRA — beneficiary designation on file?
- ☐ 401(k) — beneficiary designation on file?

VEHICLES

- ☐ Cars — name on title
- ☐ Boats, RVs, motorcycles

LIFE INSURANCE

- ☐ Beneficiary designation current?
- ☐ Is the trust named as contingent beneficiary?

BUSINESS INTERESTS

- ☐ LLC membership interest transferred to trust?
- ☐ Business succession plan in place?

DIGITAL ASSETS

- ☐ Crypto — see Crypto Inheritance Checklist
- ☐ Online accounts with significant value

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Special rule

Retirement accounts pass by beneficiary designation, NOT through a trust. Keep those designations current.

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3 Steps to Fund Your Trust

- 1 Get a copy of your trust document**
You will need the exact legal name of the trust and its date.
- 2 Contact each institution to retitle**
Call your bank, DMV, and brokerage to change ownership into the trust's name.
- 3 Verify each transfer in writing**
Get written confirmation that each asset is now titled in the trust.



Stay organized

Keep a simple list of every asset and check it off as each one is retitled. That list is proof your trust is truly funded.

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Contact & Next Steps

A funded trust is a working trust. Walk through this checklist, retitle each asset, and your protection plan will actually hold up when it matters.

We are here to help

You do not have to figure this out alone. Sentinel Enterprises helps working families and crypto holders protect what matters — in plain English, with no jargon and no pressure.

Reach Us

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